This (is) [the request] of the second queen, the mother of Tivala, the Karuvaki.[51]

The queen Karuvaki seems to have been no pushover. She wanted to be known as the giver of these gifts; the emperor informs his officers; the registration is done as she desires.

Family philanthropy is not of course sufficient, and Ashoka is at pains to point out that moral restrictions and conversion through persuasion have been his main methods for initiating change, the second of these having proved to be more meaningful: ‘moral restrictions are of little consequence; by conversion, however, (morality is promoted) more considerably.’[52] Honesty and finality resonate in this last self-reflexive statement. Through much of his life and via his edicts Ashoka had tried to communicate the need to transform state governance from a system based on force to one anchored in morality. Looking back he acknowledges the futility of restrictions imposed from above and the gentler, more effective power of persuasion for the achievement of a dharmic life and empire. It was what he wanted to say in the end to his people and successors, and he hoped his views ‘may last as long as (my) sons and great-grandsons (shall reign and) as long as the moon and the sun (shall shine), and in order that (men) may conform to it.’[53]